5. The contents are kept clear and dust free, especially where good covers and almirahs are used.

### Drawbacks of Horizontal Filing:

1. Papers cannot be taken out without dislocating other papers because the latest document is on top where a flat file is used.

2. Where a file has become bulky, location of papers become very difficult.

3. It is suitable for offices where transactions are not many.

4. This method does not allow for expansion behind a certain point.

5. It requires an index to find out the concerned file.

### 2. Vertical Filing:

This method of filing can be said to be the most modern. It is so named because the contents are kept in an upright or standing position. This method of filing is the result of the growing needs of business organization. The greatest drawback of the horizontal filing is the time consumed in locating a paper or document. As the business expands, the bulk of papers increases and location of a paper becomes difficult and time consuming activity, vertical filing eliminates this drawback of horizontal filing. Hence it has become a very popular method of filing in large offices where number of subjects is large.



*Fig. 5.5. Vertical Filing*

### Advantages of Vertical Filing:

Vertical filing offers many advantages over horizontal filing, which are summarized below:

1. **Economical:** Vertical filing is more economical on account of two reasons.

   i. The folders are cheap, and

   ii. Many folders can be accommodated by a single filing cabinet.

   Hence there is saving in terms of money as well as space.

2. **Ready Reference:** Any paper can be traced without wasting time. This is possible because there is a separate folder for each customer or subject and its contents are easily known due to description given on the tab or projected part of the back sheet. Besides, any paper can be inserted and taken out with great ease in a short time.

3. **Elasticity:** Filing cabinets provide ample scope for expansion of filing facility. A single drawer can accommodate a large number of folders. As the number of folders increases the same drawer can be accommodate more folders upto some extent.



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